

Idioms, analogies, and figures of speech

CERTAIN DEVICES ARE USED TO MAKE SPEECH AND WRITING MORE INTERESTING AND PERSUASIVE.

Figures of speech are used to create different effects, usually to emphasize a point or help an audience visualize something. Idioms would be meaningless if they were not familiar expressions, while analogies are a useful tool for explaining things.

Idioms

An idiom is a word or phrase that means something completely different from the word or words it is made up of. The meanings of idioms have little or no relation to the literal meanings of their component parts, but they make sense because they are familiar expressions. Different regions have different idioms.

This idiom is used to refer to someone who watches a lot of television.



couch potato



This idiom means "to get into bed."

hit the sack

down in the dumps

This idiom is used to refer to someone who is feeling miserable.



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Writing from personal experience	210–211 >
Writing a narrative	212–213 >

The word **metaphor** comes from the Greek word *metapherein*, which means “transfer.”

Analogies

Analogies are used to explain what something is by likening that thing to another thing and identifying similarities. An analogy is not a figure of speech, but it works like an extended metaphor or simile: It compares an unfamiliar thing to a familiar thing, and then lists the shared characteristics. Baking a cake, for instance, can be used as an analogy for writing. Both require careful planning and specific ingredients, and are designed to suit a particular audience.



Parts of speech are some of the ingredients required to create a sentence.

REAL WORLD

Avoiding clichés

Clichés are expressions or ideas that have been overused to the point where they have almost lost their original meanings and serve only to annoy the reader. Clichés such as “best-kept secret,” “expect the unexpected,” and “the best just got better” are common in slogans and advertisements, but it is always more effective to write something original.

